CHOCOLATE BUCKWHEAT TART DOUGH

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
1 tart shell, 23 cm, or 4 tartlet shells at 10 cm	**20 min**	**1 h chilled minimum or overnight, then 15 min once lined**	**about 2 h**

OVEN

325F / 160C, 13 to 15 min partially baked, 12 to 15 min longer for fully baked

INGREDIENTS

175 g	Einkorn flour
45 g	Buckwheat flour
30 g	Almond flour
2 tbsp	Cocoa powder
140 g	Unsalted butter, at room temperature
85 g	Confectioners' sugar, sifted
1	Egg, large
1	Egg white, large, beaten

METHOD

1. Sift the three flours and the cocoa powder together into a small bowl and set it aside.
2. Paddle the butter and confectioners' sugar in a stand mixer on low until smooth, then stop and scrape the bowl down with a rubber spatula.
3. Raise the speed to medium-low and beat in the whole egg. Scrape the bowl down again.
4. Back on low, add the dry mixture and run the mixer only until it disappears into the dough.
5. Turn the dough onto a lightly floured bench and knead it gently to take up any dry patches the mixer missed.
6. Flatten it into a disk 12 mm thick, wrap it tightly and chill at least 1 hour, or overnight.
7. To line a pan, roll the disk out to 3 mm on a lightly floured surface, working from the middle outward in every direction. Lift the sheet and swing it a quarter turn every few passes, dusting flour underneath when it grabs, and keep moving so the dough stays cool.
8. Cut a circle 5 cm wider than the pan.
9. While the dough is still cool, lay the circle in the pan, settle it into the bottom and up the sides, and press it home gently. Do not pull it to fit, because stretched sides shrink back in the oven.
10. If the dough has softened too far to handle, chill it a few minutes before transferring it.
11. Patch any tear with a scrap, pressing firmly so it holds. With a sharp knife, trim the edge flush with the rim of the pan.
12. Put the lined shell in the fridge or freezer until firm, about 15 minutes.
13. For tartlets, roll the dough the same way, cut circles to suit your pans and line them. Freeze whatever is left, scraps included.
14. Heat the oven to 325F. Prick the base all over with fork tines or a knife tip, tiny holes about 5 cm apart.
15. Bake a large shell 13 to 15 minutes for partially baked, or tartlet shells 8 to 10 minutes. The pastry should look dry and matte with only a little color. Turn the pans during the bake if one side is running ahead.
16. A minute or two short of the color you want, pull the shell out and brush the base and sides thinly with the beaten egg white. Return it until the color arrives and the white has set.
17. For a fully baked shell, carry on as above but give it 12 to 15 minutes more, to golden brown.
18. Cool the shells completely on wire racks.

NOTES

No salt in this dough at all, and the cocoa powder is given by volume with no weight alongside it.
One hour of chilling is enough here, where the flaky and sweet doughs both want two.
A batch lines one 23 cm shell and no more, so scale it if you need a pair.
The egg white brushed inside the shell seals the pastry against a wet filling, the same job the egg wash does on sweet tart dough.
Golden brown is the stated cue for a fully baked shell, but cocoa makes color hard to judge. Lean on the 12 to 15 extra minutes and a base that feels dry and firm.

PRESERVING

Treat it like the sweet dough it is built from. Wrapped and cold it is forgiving, and the scraps are worth keeping.
The wrapped disk needs 1 hour in the fridge at minimum and holds overnight.
Leftover dough and offcuts freeze for later shells or cookies.
A lined shell firms in the freezer in about 15 minutes and can go to the oven from there.
Baked shells keep well wrapped for 1 week refrigerated or 2 weeks frozen.